Hyunjong Ok

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Research Interests

I develop evaluation methods for **multimodal and speech-enabled language models**. My work focuses on **diagnostic benchmark design**, auditory and temporal grounding, full-duplex voice-agent evaluation, and **data-efficient evaluation and inference** that preserve model-ranking fidelity at lower cost.

Keywords: multimodal and speech LLMs, benchmark design, full-duplex interaction, efficient evaluation

Research and Industry Experience

Upstage, AI Research Engineer Intern *Dec. 2025 – May 2026*

- Developed data-efficient VLM evaluation methods that preserve model rankings while substantially reducing benchmark scale, by analyzing benchmark redundancy and item informativeness.

Naver Cloud, AI Research Engineer Intern *Mar. 2023 – Sep. 2023*

- Conducted research on knowledge-enhanced multimodal named entity recognition (SCANNER, NAACL 2024) and implemented OCR post-processing components for document-AI pipelines.

Selected Scholarships

Ph.D. Excellence Scholarship (Science and Engineering) *Jun. 2026*
Korea Student Aid Foundation

Publications

*Equal contribution.

TempCore: Are Video QA Benchmarks Temporally Grounded? A Frame Selection Sensitivity Analysis and Benchmark [Paper]
Hyunjong Ok, Jaeho Lee
Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (**EMNLP**), 2026

Speculative End-Turn Detector for Efficient Speech Chatbot Assistant [Paper]
Hyunjong Ok, Suho Yoo, Jaeho Lee
The 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (**ACL**), 2026

Lost in the Prompt Order: Revealing the Limitations of Causal Attention in Language Models [Paper]
Hyunjong Ok, Jaeho Lee
Findings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (**ACL Findings**), 2026

AuditoryBench++: Can Language Models Understand Auditory Knowledge without Hearing? [Paper]
Hyunjong Ok*, Suho Yoo*, Hyeonjun Kim, Jaeho Lee
IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech, and Signal Processing (**ICASSP**, Oral), 2026

S2Cap: A Benchmark and a Baseline for Singing Style Captioning [Paper]
Hyunjong Ok, Jaeho Lee
ACM International Conference on Information and Knowledge Management (**CIKM**, Resource Paper), 2025

Imagine to Hear: Auditory Knowledge Generation Can Be an Effective Assistant for Language Models [Paper]
Suho Yoo*, **Hyunjong Ok***, Jaeho Lee
Findings of the 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (**ACL Findings**), 2025

AudioBERT: Audio Knowledge Augmented Language Model [Paper]
Hyunjong Ok*, Suho Yoo*, Jaeho Lee
IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech, and Signal Processing (**ICASSP**), 2025

Decoding with Limited Teacher Supervision Requires Understanding When to Trust the Teacher [Paper]
Hyunjong Ok, Jegwang Ryu, Jaeho Lee
Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (**EMNLP**), 2024

SCANNER: Knowledge-Enhanced Approach for Robust Multi-modal Named Entity Recognition of Unseen Entities [Paper]
Hyunjong Ok, Taeho Kil, Sukmin Seo, Jaeho Lee
Conference of the North American Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics (**NAACL**), 2024

Post-Trained Language Model Adaptive to Extractive Summarization of Long Spoken Documents [Paper]
Hyunjong Ok, Seong-Bae Park
IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech, and Signal Processing (**ICASSP** Grand Challenge), 2023

Understanding the Effects of Distractors on Reasoning Vision-Language Models [Paper]
Jiyun Bae, **Hyunjong Ok**, Sangwoo Mo, Jaeho Lee
Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (**EMNLP**), 2026

[Preprints]
Hierarchical Compression of Vision-Language Model Benchmarks [Paper]
Hyunjong Ok, Seunggu Kang, Jaeho Lee
arXiv preprint arXiv:2609.37515, 2026

OmniKVQuant: KV Cache Quantization for Omni-LLMs [Paper]
Suho Yoo*, **Hyunjong Ok***, Jongmin Choi, Jihoo Jung, Joon Son Chung
arXiv preprint arXiv:2609.11582, 2026

[Workshops]
FinTree: Financial Dataset Pretrain Transformer Encoder for Relation Extraction [Paper]
Hyunjong Ok
Workshop on Knowledge Discovery from Unstructured Data in Financial Services (**SIGIR Workshop**), 2023

Education

POSTECH *Feb. 2024 – Present*
Integrated M.S./Ph.D. Program, Graduate School of Artificial Intelligence *Expected Aug. 2027*
Advisor: Prof. Jaeho Lee

Kyung Hee University *Feb. 2019 – Aug. 2023*
B.S. in Software Convergence, Data Science

Selected Awards

International

ICASSP 2023 MUG Grand Challenge, Track 2: Extractive Text Summarization **1st Place**
Alibaba Cloud *Feb. 2023*

SIGIR 2023 KDF Workshop Shared Task: Relation Extraction **2nd Place**
J.P. Morgan AI Research *Jun. 2023*

Kaggle **Competitions Expert**
Two Silver medals, one Bronze medal *2022*

Domestic

The 12th Conference of the Korean Artificial Intelligence Association (CKAIA) **Outstanding Paper**
Aug. 2025

The 11th Joint Conference of the Korean Artificial Intelligence Association (JKAIA) **Outstanding Paper**
Nov. 2024

National Defense AI Challenge **4th Place**
Korea Ministry of National Defense *Dec. 2023*

Korean AI Challenge: ASR Track — **4th Place**
Korea Ministry of Science and ICT — *Nov. 2023*

Korean AI Challenge: ASR Track (Minister's Award) — **1st Place**
Korea Ministry of Science and ICT — *Oct. 2022*

Legal Judgment Prediction Challenge: Text Classification — **1st Place**
Law & Company — *Dec. 2022*

Genome EC Number Classification AI Challenge — **2nd Place**
Infoboss — *Dec. 2022*

Sentence Type Classification AI Challenge — **4th Place**
Sungkyunkwan University — *Dec. 2022*

Mentoring

Suho Yoo, M.S. Student at KAIST — *Aug. 2024 – Sep. 2025*
Research mentoring leading to publications at ICASSP 2025 and ACL Findings 2025

Academic Service

Conference Reviewer: ACL Rolling Review (ARR), NeurIPS, CIKM

Technical Skills

Programming: Python
Frameworks and Tools: PyTorch, Hugging Face, Docker, Linux, Git, Slurm